A F T E R L I F E

USER GUIDE

private freelancer terminal · tor hidden service

AFTERLIFE is a private, anonymous freelancer platform accessible exclusively through the Tor network. This guide covers everything you need to connect, find work, post contracts, communicate securely, and manage your reputation on the platform.

ACCESS · Tor hidden service (.onion address)

PROTOCOL · Encrypted JSON over TCP

PRIVACY · No accounts linked to real identity

TRANSPORT · All traffic routed through proxychains + Tor

```
A F T E R L I F E
private freelancer terminal

[ AUTH // SESSION GATE ]
available actions: login, register, quit

auth@gateway> login
nickname> afterlife
password>
```

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[1] GETTING STARTED

AFTERLIFE is only accessible through the Tor network. You will need Tor running on your machine and proxychains configured to route traffic through it. Your operator will provide you with the current .onion address.

1.1 Prerequisites

Tor	Running locally (sudo systemctl start tor)
proxychains	Configured to use 127.0.0.1:9050
Python 3	Version 3.8 or newer
client.py	The AFTERLIFE terminal client script
.onion addr	Provided by the platform operator

1.2 Launching the Client

Open a terminal and run the following command, replacing the address with the one provided to you:

```
proxychains python3 client.py --host <your.onion> --port 2077
```

■ The connection may take 10–30 seconds on first attempt. Tor routing introduces latency — this is normal and expected.

1.3 Login Screen

On successful connection, you will reach the authentication gateway. Type login or register and press Enter.

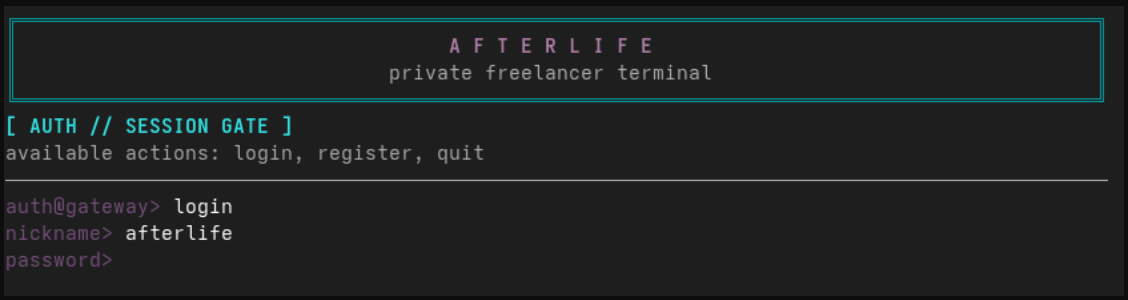

Fig 1. — Authentication gateway. Type 'login' or 'register'.

1.4 Registering an Account

Choose register to create a new account. You will be prompted for a nickname and a password. Rules for both are shown below.

Nickname	3–12 characters. Letters, digits, and underscore only.
Password	Minimum 8 characters. No length maximum.
Identity	No email, phone, or real name required.

■ Your nickname is your permanent identity on the platform. Choose carefully — it cannot be changed.

1.5 Logging In

Choose login, enter your nickname and password. A session token is issued automatically and used for all subsequent requests. Only one active session is allowed per account —

logging in from a second location will invalidate the first.

[2] THE JOB BOARD

The job board lists all active contracts on the platform. You can filter by status and browse contracts from all users who have not blocked you.

2.1 Browsing Contracts

From the main menu, choose open jobs to see all currently open contracts. Each listing shows the contract ID, title, reward, status, acceptance count, author, and minimum reputation required.

```
A F T E R L I F E
private freelancer terminal

[ JOB BOARD // OPEN CONTRACTS ]
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
[proxychains] Strict chain  ...  127.0.0.1:9050  ...  4gt5hy36cq73dygndeekbyg66avdiwumhjfxcnnsx3n4gjt6jnlfrqid.onion:2077  ...  OK
[ CONTRACT #0002 ]
Private Job Example
Reward          : 100
Min rep         : 0
Status          : ● OPEN
Accepts         : 0
Author          : afterlife
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
[ CONTRACT #0001 ]
Welcome to AFTERLIFE
Reward          : 1000
Min rep         : 0
Status          : ● OPEN
Accepts         : 0
Author          : afterlife
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────

[ press enter to continue ]
```

Fig 2. — Job board showing two open contracts.

2.2 Contract Status Values

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
● OPEN	Contract is accepting workers	Visible in the open jobs list
● DONE	Contract has been completed	Worker was selected and marked done
● CANCELLED	Contract was cancelled by the author	No longer accepting workers

2.3 Minimum Reputation Requirement

Some contracts require a minimum reputation score to accept. If your reputation is below the required threshold, the contract will be visible but you will not be able to apply. The Min rep field shows the required score; your own score is shown when you open the contract details.

> ■ Reputation can be negative. A contract with Min rep: -5 is accessible to users with a score of -5 or higher.

[3] CONTRACT DETAILS

Opening a contract shows you its full details, including the decrypted description (if you have access), the worker pool, and context-sensitive action commands.

3.1 Viewing a Contract

From the job board, choose job details and enter the contract ID. The detail view refreshes live after each action.

```
A F T E R L I F E
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[ CONTRACT DETAILS // LIVE VIEW ]

[ CONTRACT #0001 // SECURE VIEW ]

Welcome to AFTERLIFE
.....................................................................................
Reward          : 1000
Min rep         : 0
Status          : ● OPEN
Author          : afterlife
Private         : no
Accepts         : 0
Your reputation: 0

[ DESCRIPTION // DECRYPTED ]
  Here is where you put your job details. Be brief and objective.

[ ACCEPTED WORKERS ]
  no workers assigned yet.

commands: back, select worker, done, cancelled, reopen, delete
contract@view>
```

Fig 3. — Contract detail view for a public contract. Description is decrypted.

3.2 Accepting a Contract

If the contract is open, you meet the reputation requirement, and you are not the author, an accept command will appear. Type accept to apply. The contract author will be notified via a system message in your shared chat.

```
A F T E R L I F E
private freelancer terminal

[ CONTRACT DETAILS // LIVE VIEW ]

[ CONTRACT #0001 // SECURE VIEW ]

Welcome to AFTERLIFE
.....................................................................................
Reward          : 1000
Min rep         : 0
Status          : ● OPEN
Author          : afterlife
Private         : no
Accepts         : 0
Your reputation: 0

[ DESCRIPTION // DECRYPTED ]
  Here is where you put your job details. Be brief and objective.

commands: back, accept
contract@view> accept
[proxychains] Strict chain  ...  127.0.0.1:9050  ...  4gt5hy36cq73dygndeekbyg66avdiwumhjfxcnnsx3n4gjt6jnlfrqid.onion:2077  ...  OK
.....................................................................................
[ OK ] Job accepted.

[ press enter to continue ]
```

Fig 4. — Accepting a public contract. A chat is automatically created with the author.

3.3 Withdrawing Your Application

If you change your mind before being selected, type withdraw from the contract detail view. You cannot withdraw after the author has selected you as the worker.

[4] POSTING A CONTRACT

Any authenticated user can post a contract. From the main menu, choose create job. You will be prompted for the following fields.

title	Short name for the contract. 1–32 characters.
description	Full details of the work required. 1–256 characters.
reward	Numeric value representing the payment. 1–99,999,999.
min reputation	Minimum reputation score required to accept. Can be negative.
private?	Whether the description should be token-locked (yes/no).

■ Forbidden characters in all text fields: single quote, double quote, backslash, forward slash, percent sign, plus sign.

4.1 Creating a Public Contract

A public contract is visible to all users who meet the reputation requirement. The description is decrypted and readable by anyone who opens the contract details.

```
                    A F T E R L I F E
              private freelancer terminal

[ CREATE CONTRACT // BROADCAST ]
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
forbidden characters in text fields: ' " \ / % +
..............................................................................
title> Welcome to AFTERLIFE
description> Here is where you put your job details. Be brief and objective.
reward> 1000
minimum reputation [can be negative]> 0
private contract? [yes/no]> no
[proxychains] Strict chain  ...  127.0.0.1:9050  ...  4gt5hy36cq73dygndeekbyg66avdiwumhjfxcnnsx3n4gjt6jnlfrqid.onion:2077  ...  OK
..............................................................................
[ OK ] Job created.
Contract        : 1

[ press enter to continue ]
```

Fig 5. — Creating a public contract. Contract #0001 was assigned ID 1.

[5] PRIVATE CONTRACTS

Private contracts allow you to restrict who can read the job description and apply for the work. When you mark a contract private, the system generates a one-time private token that you must distribute manually to your intended workers.

5.1 Creating a Private Contract

Set private? to yes when creating a job. After creation, the platform displays a private token — a short random string. Copy and store this token immediately. It will not be shown again.

```
A F T E R L I F E
private freelancer terminal

[ CREATE CONTRACT // BROADCAST ]

forbidden characters in text fields: ' " \ / % +
title> Private Job Example
description> Private Jobs generate a password. You should share the password with the ones you want to work with.
reward> 100
minimum reputation [can be negative]> 5
private contract? [yes/no]> yes
[proxychains] Strict chain  ...  127.0.0.1:9050  ...  4gt5hy36cq73dygndeekbyg66avdiwumhjfxcnnsx3n4gjt6jnlfrqid.onion:2077  ...  OK
[ OK ] Job created.
Contract        : 2
[ PRIVATE TOKEN // STORE SECURELY ]
bsaOH-JSoLmw96XnRMViUA

[ press enter to continue ]
```

Fig 6. — A private contract was created. The private token is shown once.

■ STORE THE TOKEN SECURELY. If you lose it, there is no way to recover it. You will need to delete and re-post the contract.

5.2 How the Token System Works

The private token acts as both an unlock key and an acceptance credential. A worker who has the token can:

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
Unlock	Read the full contract description	Enter the token when viewing job details
Accept	Apply for the contract	Token required to submit the application

Workers without the token see the contract on the board with a DESCRIPTION LOCKED notice and cannot apply.

5.3 Viewing a Private Contract (As a Worker)

```
A F T E R L I F E
private freelancer terminal

[ CONTRACT DETAILS // LIVE VIEW ]

[ CONTRACT #0002 // SECURE VIEW ]

Private Job Example
.....................................................................................
Reward          : 100
Min rep         : 0
Status          : ● OPEN
Author          : afterlife
Private         : yes
Accepts         : 0
Your reputation: 0

[ DESCRIPTION LOCKED ] provide unlock token or be the author/admin.

commands: back, accept
contract@view>
```

Fig 7. — A private contract viewed without the token. Description is locked.

To unlock: open the contract details and enter the private token when prompted. The description will then be decrypted and displayed, and the accept action will become available.

[6] MANAGING YOUR CONTRACTS

As a contract author you have full control over its lifecycle. The commands select worker, done, cancelled, and reopen are only shown when you are the author (or an admin).

6.1 Contract Lifecycle

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
open	Contract is live and accepting workers	Default status on creation
select worker	Assign one accepted worker as the chosen contractor	Worker ID from the worker pool
done	Mark the contract as completed	Requires a selected worker first
cancelled	Cancel the contract	Workers are not removed from pool
reopen	Return a cancelled contract to open	Cannot reopen a done contract

■ A contract marked done cannot be reopened or cancelled. Done is a terminal state. The selected worker receives +1 reputation automatically.

6.2 Viewing Your Authored Contracts

From the main menu, choose my authored jobs to see all contracts you have posted, regardless of status. Choose my accepted to see contracts you have applied to.

6.3 Reputation Bonus on Completion

When you mark a contract as done, the selected worker automatically receives +1 reputation. This incentivises timely completion and good communication between parties.

[7] PRIVATE MESSAGES

All messages between users are encrypted at rest using Fernet symmetric encryption. The platform stores only encrypted ciphertext — messages cannot be read by anyone without the server master key.

7.1 How Chats Are Created

A chat between two users is created automatically when a worker accepts a contract. A system message is inserted confirming the event. You can also open a chat manually from the chats menu by typing open and entering a nickname.

7.2 Chat Inbox

```
A F T E R L I F E
private freelancer terminal

[ PRIVATE MESSAGES // ENCRYPTED ]
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
[proxychains] Strict chain  ...  127.0.0.1:9050  ...  4gt5hy36cq73dygndeekbyg66avdiwumhjfxcnnsx3n4gjt6jnlfrqid.onion:2077  ...  OK
[ CHAT #0001 ]  afterlife
Updated         : 2026-04-18 10:03
Unread          : 1
  corvo accepted your job Welcome to AFTERLIFE
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
commands: open, view, read, send, back
chat@node> send
chat id> 1
message> Hello, I just accepted the job
[proxychains] Strict chain  ...  127.0.0.1:9050  ...  4gt5hy36cq73dygndeekbyg66avdiwumhjfxcnnsx3n4gjt6jnlfrqid.onion:2077  ...  OK
..............................................................................
[ OK ] Message sent.

[ press enter to continue ] ▌
```

Fig 8. — Inbox showing one unread message. Sending a reply.

The inbox shows all your conversations with unread counts. Commands available from the chat menu:

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
open	Start a new chat with a user by nickname	Prompts for target nickname
view	Read all messages in a chat	Shows full conversation history
send	Send a new message to a chat	Prompts for chat ID and message text
read	Read a single message by ID	Marks message as read
back	Return to the main menu	

7.3 Reading a Conversation

```
A F T E R L I F E
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[ PRIVATE MESSAGES // CHAT VIEW ]

[ CHAT #0001 WITH corvo ]

#0001  2026-04-18 10:02  system
  corvo accepted your job Welcome to AFTERLIFE
.....
#0002  2026-04-18 10:03  corvo
  Hello, I just accepted the job
.....

[ press enter to continue ]
```

Fig 9. — Chat view showing system message and user reply.

System messages (shown in yellow) are generated automatically by the platform for events like contract acceptance. User messages show the sender nickname and timestamp.

7.4 Message Rules

Max length	128 characters per message
Character set	Letters, digits, spaces, and common punctuation
Rate limit	10 messages per 30 seconds per session
Encryption	All message bodies encrypted at rest with Fernet
Blocked users	Messages cannot be sent to users you have blocked or who have blocked you

[8] REPUTATION SYSTEM

Reputation is a numerical score attached to each user that reflects their standing in the community. It starts at 0 and can increase or decrease based on ratings from other users and contract completions.

8.1 How Reputation Changes

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
+1	Contract completed	Automatic, when author marks a contract done
+1	Positive rating	Another user rates you positively
-1	Negative rating	Another user rates you negatively

8.2 Rating Another User

From the main menu, choose rate. Enter the target's nickname and then choose positive or negative.

```
A F T E R L I F E
private freelancer terminal

[ REPUTATION // RATE USER ]
──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────
nickname> corvo
rating [positive/negative]> positive
[proxychains] Strict chain  ...  127.0.0.1:9050  ...  4gt5hy36cq73dygndeekbyg66avdiwumhjfxcnnsx3n4gjt6jnlfrqid.onion:2077  ...  OK
..............................................................................
[ OK ] Rating set to positive.

[ press enter to continue ]
```

Fig 10. — Rating a user. 'Rating set to positive' confirms success.

8.3 Rating Rules

Cooldown	You can only change a rating once every 24 hours
Self-rating	You cannot rate yourself
Blocked users	You cannot rate users you have blocked or who blocked you
Banned users	Banned users cannot be rated
Admin users	Admin accounts have the same reputation rules as regular users
Min rep capped	A job's min reputation cannot exceed the author's own reputation

✓ Reputation affects which contracts you can accept. Build a positive score by completing contracts reliably and receiving good ratings.

[9] BLOCK LIST

Blocking a user filters them from your experience across the entire platform. Blocks are bidirectional — both parties are affected.

9.1 What Blocking Does

Job board	Their contracts are hidden from your board view
Messages	You cannot send or receive messages with them
Contracts	You cannot accept their contracts (and vice versa)
Ratings	You cannot rate each other
History	Existing messages and ratings are not deleted

9.2 Blocking and Unblocking

From the main menu, choose blocks. Use the block and unblock commands by entering the target nickname. Admin accounts cannot be blocked.

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
block	Block a user by nickname	Prevents all interaction
unblock	Remove a block	Restores normal interaction
back	Return to main menu	

[10] COMMAND REFERENCE

The following is a complete reference of all commands available at each menu prompt.

AUTH GATEWAY (auth@gateway>)

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
login	Log in with nickname and password	
register	Create a new account	Nickname 3–12 chars, password min 8
quit	Exit the client	Also: q, exit

MAIN MENU (afterlife@node>)

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
open jobs	Browse open contracts	Also: open
done jobs	Browse completed contracts	Also: done
cancelled jobs	Browse cancelled contracts	Also: cancelled
create job	Post a new contract	Also: create
job details	View a contract by ID	Also: details
my authored jobs	Contracts you posted	Also: my jobs
my accepted	Contracts you applied to	Also: accepted
profile	Your identity and reputation	
rate	Rate another user	
blocks	Manage your block list	
chats	Private encrypted messages	
logout	End session and return to auth	
quit	Exit the client	Also: exit

CONTRACT DETAIL VIEW (contract@view>)

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
back	Return to previous screen	Also: b
accept	Apply for the contract	Visible when eligible
withdraw	Withdraw your application	Visible if you have applied
select worker	Choose a worker from the pool	Author/admin only
done	Mark contract as completed	Author/admin only, requires selected worker
cancelled	Cancel the contract	Author/admin only
reopen	Re-open a cancelled contract	Author/admin only
delete	Permanently delete the contract	Admin only

CHAT MENU (chat@node>)

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES

open	Start a new chat with a user	Prompts for nickname
view	View all messages in a chat	Prompts for chat ID
send	Send a message	Prompts for chat ID and message
read	Read a single message by ID	Marks it as read
back	Return to main menu	

BLOCKS MENU (blocks@node>)

COMMAND	ACTION	NOTES
block	Block a user by nickname	
unblock	Unblock a user	
back	Return to main menu	

■ For operational security: never share your session token, private tokens, or .onion address on clearnet channels. Always connect through Tor. Never reuse passwords from other services.

AFTERLIFE · private freelancer terminal · end of user guide